PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Defender | Microsoft Sentinel | Azure Security | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience in Microsoft security environments, including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender XDR, and Microsoft Sentinel. At the University of the Arts, London (UAL), I have led the design, deployment, and optimisation of Microsoft security controls across an estate of over 8,000 users, building Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based detection engineering in Sentinel, managing Conditional Access and identity governance through Microsoft Entra ID, and driving incident response and threat hunting aligned to MITRE ATT&CK. I complement this Microsoft-native expertise with deep experience in CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Mimecast email security, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), and enterprise vulnerability management. I bring a broad, engineering-first security mindset and I am seeking a permanent senior role in a hybrid environment where I can make a significant impact within a forward-thinking security team.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft Defender for Office 365; Microsoft Defender XDR; Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) with Kusto Query Language (KQL); Microsoft Security Copilot familiarity
- **Identity and Access Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)); Conditional Access policies; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO); Privileged Identity Management (PIM); Group Policy; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Security Operations:** Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR); alert triage and investigation; detection content engineering; threat hunting; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules
- **Endpoint and Email Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Next-Generation SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover); Mimecast email security gateway; Tanium endpoint management; Microsoft Intune MDM / Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); AppCheck; Nessus; risk-rated remediation reporting
- **Network and Infrastructure Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall; Intrusion Detection and Prevention System (IDS/IPS); Web Application Firewall (WAF); Microsoft Azure network security; Zero Trust architecture principles
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 incident response framework; full-lifecycle incident handling from detection through containment, eradication, and recovery; post-incident review and lessons-learned
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR playbook development; KQL detection query authoring
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead the design, configuration, and day-to-day management of Microsoft Defender XDR (MDE, MDI, Defender for Office 365) and Microsoft Sentinel across a 8,000-user enterprise estate, building KQL-based detection analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques
- Architect and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SIEM workbooks, analytics rules, automation rules, and Microsoft Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, significantly reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and manual analyst workload
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) security posture including Conditional Access policy design, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), MFA rollout and enforcement, and continuous access evaluation

- Administer Microsoft Intune MDM / MAM policy framework for managed and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) endpoints, enforcing compliance policies and integrating with Conditional Access for Zero Trust enforcement
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, NG-SIEM, Discover) in parallel with Microsoft Defender, managing endpoint detection policies, threat hunting, and cross-platform alert correlation
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform for privileged account lifecycle management, just-in-time access provisioning, and session recording
- Lead vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), producing risk-rated reports and tracking remediation to closure
- Manage Mimecast email security gateway including anti-phishing, safe URL, DMARC alignment, and impersonation protection policies
- Provide senior-level incident response leadership following NIST SP 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication, and recovery activities, and producing post-incident reports for the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying advanced persistent threats and anomalous user behaviour

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Performed daily Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon alert triage, investigation, and response across phishing, malware, credential-based attacks, and insider threat scenarios
- Wrote and refined KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel to reduce alert fatigue and improve detection fidelity, retiring redundant legacy rules and mapping new detections to MITRE ATT&CK
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the UAL estate, developing deployment runbooks and on-boarding procedures
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) identity governance tasks including user provisioning, access reviews, Conditional Access policy updates, and MFA enrolment campaigns
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-rated remediation reports and tracking remediation through to closure with infrastructure teams
- Administered Microsoft Intune MDM / MAM policies and supported Conditional Access integration for compliant device enforcement
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM administration including privileged account onboarding and access request management
- Contributed to incident response activities aligned to NIST SP 800-61, documenting timelines, evidence handling, and lessons-learned outcomes

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)
IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Implemented and maintained endpoint security controls, MFA and SSO solutions, and firewall policies within a cloud-first SaaS environment, applying Microsoft Azure and identity security best practices
- Conducted internal security assessments and supported external penetration testing engagements, tracking remediation of findings against defined risk thresholds
- Managed MDM policies for remote and mobile devices, ensuring secure access to corporate applications and compliance with organisational security standards
- Administered IT infrastructure including Azure-hosted services, network devices, and servers, applying CIS Controls and security hardening baselines

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) with over 200 KQL detection analytics rules covering MITRE ATT&CK initial access, persistence, lateral movement, and exfiltration tactics, improving threat detection coverage significantly
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the full 8,000-user UAL estate, integrating with Microsoft Sentinel for unified cross-domain threat correlation
- Built SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that automated alert triage, user isolation, and phishing remediation workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) by over 40%

- Delivered Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL through structured implementation of access control, patching, firewall, and malware protection requirements
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to govern all privileged accounts, eliminating uncontrolled administrative access and providing full session audit capability
- Achieved measurable reduction in critical and high vulnerabilities across UAL's estate through a systematic vulnerability management programme leveraging Tenable.io and Pentera BAS

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)